Acme Corp four-day week pilot: internal evaluation memo

Prepared by the People Analytics team, March 2026. Fictional test document bundled with the evaluation suite of the Multi-Agent Deep Researcher project; all figures are invented.

1. Design

Acme Corp ran a 14-week pilot of a four-day, 32-hour week in two business units: Customer Support (118 staff) and Product Engineering (74 staff). Pay was unchanged. A control group of 96 staff in Finance and Legal kept the five-day schedule. Output was measured with existing operational metrics rather than self-report: resolved tickets per agent-hour in Support, and merged change requests per engineer-week in Engineering.

2. Results

- **Output per hour rose 6.4%** across both units (Support +7.9%, Engineering +4.1%). Total weekly output fell 2.1% because hours fell 20%.
- **Voluntary attrition fell from an annualised 19% to 9%** in the pilot units; the control group was unchanged at 18%.
- **Customer satisfaction was flat** (CSAT 4.31 vs 4.29 before the pilot), with a 9% rise in next-day response times on Fridays, when staffing was thinnest.
- **Sick days fell 23%** in the pilot units and rose 4% in the control group.
- Managers reported that meetings were cut by about a third; 61% of pilot staff said they worked more intensely during the four days.

3. Limitations

The pilot was short (14 weeks), the business units volunteered, and the Engineering output measure counts merged change requests regardless of size. Hours were self-reported in Engineering, so the output-per-hour figure there is less reliable than in Support, where hours are logged by the phone system. Seasonal effects were not controlled: the pilot ran over a quieter quarter.

4. Recommendation

Extend the pilot to 12 months, add a size-weighted output measure for Engineering, and staff Fridays at 60% rather than 50% to protect response times. The committee does not recommend a company-wide rollout until the Friday service gap is closed.